



SYMPTOMS LIE

And in bone stress injuries, they lie most where it matters most.



PAIN IS A PROTECTION SYSTEM

It is easy to assume worse pain means a worse injury. In bone stress, that assumption can cost months.

You can carry a serious bone stress injury with very little pain, especially at the highest risk sites. So how much it hurts is a weak guide to how much danger it holds.

HIGH RISK SITES THAT HIDE

Navicular	missed for an average of 8.8 months
Anterior shin	classically a mild ache that lets you keep running
Femoral neck	often mistaken for a hip flexor strain



LOWER RISK SITES THAT MASK

Posterior shin	can present as calf tightness, not pain
Fibula	sometimes just swelling or a drop in push off power

When shin pain is actually assessed, a large share turns out to be a bone stress injury, not a muscle (Nussbaum et al 2019).

SOME BREAK **ALMOST SILENTLY**

Documented anterior tibial stress fractures have had a **negative early MRI**, a real fracture under a scan that looked clean (Smith).

Others stayed symptom light until the bone completed and displaced (Finestone et al 2006). Quiet does not mean safe.



RISK LIVES IN **TWO PLACES**

Pain is not a proxy for severity. The real risk sits in the injury and the person, not in how loud it feels.

THE INJURY

which site, how it loads, how
it heals

THE PERSON

training load, energy
availability, history



WHY THE SITE **MATTERS**

4x

RETURN TO SPORT FAILURE

3x

COMPLICATION RATE

High risk sites carry roughly four times the return to sport failure and three times the complications of low risk ones.



SO I BUILT SOMETHING FOR EXACTLY THIS

BIRA

BONE INJURY RISK ASSESSMENT

A free tool that helps you make sense of your symptoms in context, weighing the injury and the person, not just how much it hurts.

Now live.



PAIN IS NOT A PROXY FOR SEVERITY

Understand what is really driving your bone stress risk.

@stressfracturephysio

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